

Qi or otherwise unfortunately. The glass accent on the back was merely for aesthetics and to hide ugly plastic antenna bands ruining the seamlessness of the back chassis. As an added bonus, it also supported Google's very own Daydream (Which, surprise surprise, Booman didn't like very much: <http://dgit.in/DaydrmBoo>) and was also one of the few phones on the excellent Project Fi list. Here are our reviews of the Pixel (<http://dgit.in/GglPixl>) and Pixel XL (<http://dgit.in/PixlXL>), in case you want a refresher.

The Pixel launch was peppered with snide jabs at Apple and specifically the iPhone 7. This was done ostensibly to draw the crowd who were upgrading from an iPhone 5s/6 to the Pixel instead of the iPhone 7. Gibes included the fact that both the Pixel and it's bigger brother, the XL shared the same internals and camera instead of locking away better features in the more expensive Plus models a la iPhones, and that the Pixel had the all important 3.5mm headphone jack (being courageous indeed). Special mention was made as to how you can get all your data, even iMessages transferred to your new Pixel within 5 minutes. And also Apple's color naming scheme was mocked – Quite Black > Jet/Black any day.

The Pixel was received pretty well and the sort-of specially targeted demographic of people upgrading from the iPhone 5s/6 who were disap-



Even the Pixel 2 took a not-quite-subtle jab at the iPhone

pointed with the stale design and trade-offs made by the iPhone 7, all eagerly bought into the hype – at least at first. Then the problems started cropping up. For starters, the Pixel was almost never in stock leading to disappointed customers everywhere. Google didn't anticipate that the iPhone 7 would have these many detractors and that the Pixel would sell so well and therefore were a little underprepared on the stock front. HTC, the contract manufacturer stepped up the production but still, a lot of potential customers got fed up and frustrated with the wait and bought other phones instead (Here is some nice tech trivia – a lot of people seem to think that Pixel were manufactured by Google themselves, but originally Huawei was approached to be the contract manufacturer but they refused since Google wouldn't let them put their brand name on the device. Therefore HTC stepped in). “The